



"NORTH INDIA TRIP - 12 Nights"

Meal plan – Half board basis

Day 01

Arrival Delhi By International flight

Arrive at Indira Gandhi International airport in the Evening hrs

Meet, Greet & Welcome at the airport by our office representative & transfer to hotel.

DELHI: New Delhi, the capital and the third largest city of India is a fusion of the ancient and the modern. Standing along the West End of Gangetic Plain, the capital city, Delhi, unwinds a picture rich with culture, architecture and human diversity, deep in history, monuments, museums, galleries, gardens and exotic shows. Comprising of two contrasting yet harmonious parts, the Old Delhi and New Delhi, the city is a travel hub of Northern India.



buildings.

Narrating the city's Mughal past, Old Delhi, takes you through the labyrinthine streets passing through formidable mosques, monuments and forts. You will also discover lively and colorful bazaars that boast to cater all sorts of good and items at mind-blowing prices amidst a barely controlled chaotic ambience. The imperial city of New Delhi displays the finely curved architecture of British Raj. It generates a mesmerizing charm reflecting well-composed and spacious streets under the shade of beautifully lined avenues of trees and tall and imposing government

On arrival Check-In at hotel

Overnight at hotel

Day 02

In Delhi

Breakfast at hotel

Start your tour with visit of **Shahjahanbad (Old Delhi)**

The 300-year-old walled city, built by the Mughal Emperor Shah Jehan in 1648 as his capital. The focus of the city is the magnificent Red Fort and Jama Mosque built of red sandstone. Drive past the Red Fort from where the Prime Minister of India addresses the nation on India's Independence Day.

Enjoy a Cycle rickshaw ride through the busy bazaars of the Chandani Chowk area

Visit Jama Masjid, the most elegant mosque in India that stands high on a hillock. In between and around these two focal points of the 17th century city is a thriving modern city in medieval setting. This area once had a tree-lined central avenue, with a canal dividing the thoroughfare.

Also visit Raj Ghat, Mahatma Gandhi's shrine.

Further proceed to visit New Delhi - the early 20th century British capital, designed by Sir Edward Lutyens and Herbert Baker. Drive past *the President's House, the Rashtrapati Bhavan and the two flanking Secretariat buildings* – the nerve centre of Government activity. Driving down this hill is the India Gate, the great memorial arch built to commemorate the slain heroes of World War -1 and Indo-Afghan war. Around India Gate are palaces of some erstwhile princely states that are now public offices and museums.

Proceed to Gurudwara Bangla Sahib - is one of the most prominent Sikh gurdwaras, or Sikh house of worship, in Delhi, India, and known for its association with the eighth Sikh Guru, Guru Har Krishan, as well as the holy pond inside its complex, known as the "Sarovar." It was first built as a small shrine by Sikh General Sardar Baghel Singh in 1783, on the bungalow donated by king Raja Jai Singh of Amer, who supervised the construction of nine Sikh shrines in Delhi in the same year, during the reign of Mughal Emperor, Shah Alam II.

End your trip with visit to Qutab Minar: Qutab Minar is at 72.5 meters the world's tallest brick minaret. Construction commenced in 1193 under the orders of India's first Muslim ruler Qutab-ud-din Aibak, and the topmost storey of the minaret was completed in 1386 by Firuz Shah Tughluq. The Qutab Minar is notable for being one of the earliest and most prominent examples of Indo-Islamic architecture. It is surrounded by several other ancient and medieval structures and ruins, collectively known as Qutab complex. The complex is listed as a [UNESCO World Heritage Site](#)



Return to hotel by evening

Dinner & Overnight at hotel

Day 03

**Drive Delhi-Mandawa
(270 kms/6-7 hrs)**

Breakfast at hotel

Check Out from hotel & transfer to Mandawa

Mandawa: A lovely, subdued little market town. Mandawa is an excellent base for exploring the region. It was settled in the 18th century, and fortified by the dominant merchant families.

On arrival check-in at hotel

Afternoon visit Havelis - The popular design was a building, which from the outside was relatively unremarkable, the focus being the one or more internal courtyards. This served the purposes of security and privacy for the women, as well as offering some relief from the fierce heat which grips the area in summer. The plain exteriors also made the houses easily defensible

Evening at leisure

Dinner & Overnight stay at hotel

Day 04	Drive Mandawa-Bikaner (190 kms/4 hrs drive)
---------------	--

Breakfast at hotel

Check Out from hotel & transfer to Bikaner

Bikaner - Rao Bikaji, a descendant of the founder of Jodhpur, founded this desert town in the north of the state in 1488. Like many others in Rajasthan, the old city is surrounded by high crenellated walls and was once an important staging post on the great caravan trade routes. The city is chiefly interesting for its superb large fort, but is also known for the fine camel's bread here.

On arrival, Check-In at hotel

Afternoon visit **Junagarh Fort:** It is an unassailable fortress, which had never been conquered. Built in 1593 A.D. by Raja Rai Singh, one of the most distinguished generals in the army of Emperor Akbar, the fort is a formidable structure encircled by a moat. The main entrance to the fort is Karan Pol [gate] that is facing east. Next to it is the Suraj Pol meaning the sun gate. In the fort complex are some magnificent palaces like Anup Mahal, Ganga Niwas and Rang Mahal or palace of pleasure. The Har Mandir is the majestic chapel for the royal family for worshipping their gods and goddesses. These palaces, constructed in red sandstone and marble, make a picturesque ensemble of courtyards, balconies, kiosks and windows dotted all over the structure. The premises also house a museum, which has an array of rich collection.



Also enjoy a TUK TUK in the Old Markets of Bikaner town

National Research Center (10 km): Spend some time with the indispensable ship of the desert at the camel research and breeding centres which is only one of its kinds in Asia. The farm extends over 2000 acres of semi-arid land and is managed by the Government of India.

Dinner & Overnight stay at hotel

Day 05**Drive Bikaner-Jodhpur
(235 kms/4-5 hrs drive)**

Breakfast at hotel

Check Out & drive to Jodhpur

Jodhpur: At the edge of the Thar Desert, stands the 2nd largest city of Rajasthan – Jodhpur. The city is totally dominated by the massive fort, topping a sheer hill which rises right in the middle of the town. Founded in 1459 by Rao Jodha, a chief of the Rajput clan known as the Rathores. The Rathore kingdom was once known as Marwar, the Land of Death. It's fascinating to wander around the jumble of winding streets in the old city. Eight gates lead out from the walled city. It's one of India's most interesting cities and, yes, it was from here that those baggy-tights horse-riding trousers, Jodhpuries took their name.

Upon arrival, Check-in to the hotel

Afternoon **visit Mehrangarh fort & Jaswant Thada** – an imposing white marble cenotaph built to commemorate the acts of bravery and generosity of the rulers in 19th century



Mehrangarh Fort– founded in 1459 ad by Rao Jodha (after whom the city is named) the fort is intricately adorned with long carved panels and latticed windows of exquisite designs in Red Sandstone.

After visit, walking tour to local Bazaars & Clock tower area

Dinner & Overnight stay at hotel

Day 06**Drive Jodhpur-Jaipur
(335 kms/6 hrs drive)**

Breakfast at hotel

Check Out from hotel & transfer to Jaipur

Enroute visiting Pushkar: Situated right on the edge of the desert, is this town clinging to the side of a small but beautiful Pushkar Lake, with its many bathing ghats and temples. It's world famous for camel and cattle fair. At this time the town is thronged with tribal people from all over Rajasthan & Pilgrims from all over India. There are many temples, though few are as ancient as you might expect at such a pilgrimage site, since many were destroyed by Aurangzeb and subsequently rebuilt. The most famous is the only temple in India dedicated to Brahma. It's marked by a red spire and over the entrance gateway is the Hans (goose symbol of Brahma).



Continue drive to Jaipur

Jaipur: The capital city of the state of Rajasthan is popularly known as the "Pink City" because of the pink paint applied to the buildings in the old walled city. (In Rajput culture, pink was traditionally a colour associated with hospitality) The city owes its name, its foundation and its careful planning to the great warrior, astronomer Maharaja Jai Singh II (1699-1744). In 1727, with Mughal power on the wane, Jai Singh decided the time was ripe to move down from his somewhat cramped hillside fortress at nearby Amber to the new site. He laid out the city, with its surrounding walls and six rectangular blocks, according to principles of town planning set down in the Shilpa-Shastra, an ancient Hindu treatise on architecture

Dinner & Overnight stay at hotel**Day 07****In Jaipur****Breakfast at hotel**

Morning visit Fort Amber by Elephant/Jeep - ***Ascent to the fort on Elephants; Return to base by jeeps.***

Amber Fort 11 kms from Jaipur – marvellous example of Rajput architecture with its terraces and ramparts reflected in the Maota Lake below. The fort interior has various royal halls decorated with intricate ivory work, exquisite wall paintings and tiny mirror chips, which create a tantalizing reflection effect. **Enroute to Fort; Photo stop at Hawa Mahal**



Afternoon city tour of Jaipur includes:



City Palace museum – an imposing blend of traditional Rajasthani and Mughal Art. The museum is resplendent with its collection of robes of Royal Princes, carpets, an armory of old weapons, miniature paintings portraying court scenes, battle scenes and processions. **Also visit Jantar Mantar (observatory)** – which is the largest stone and marble crafted observatory in the world. Situated near

the gate of the City Palace, the observatory has 17 curiously shaped instruments, many of them still in working condition

Also experience a ride on the traditional Cycle Rickshaw. Enjoy a ride through the bustling city area of Jaipur.....

Evening – Indian Home Visit, Cultural Interaction & Culinary Experience:-

This evening, experience authentic Indian hospitality with an exclusive visit to a local family's home. Upon arrival, you will be warmly welcomed by your hosts for an insightful conversation on Indian lifestyle, family values, and age-old cultural traditions over refreshing drinks. Following the interaction, your host will lead a hands-on cooking demonstration, walking you through the subtle art of Indian spice blending and the preparation of iconic regional delicacies. The evening culminates in a delightful, home-cooked dinner shared with the family, offering a true taste of Indian warmth and culinary tradition.

Return to hotel for Overnight stay

Day 08

**Drive Jaipur-Agra
5-6 hrs drive**

**Breakfast at hotel
Check Out & drive to Agra**

En route visiting Fatehpursikri - The deserted red sandstone city that was built by Emperor Akbar as his capital. It was a veritable fairy tale city and its 'ruins' are still in a pristine condition. It is not hard to imagine what the court life must have been like in the days of its grandeur.



After visit, continue trip to Agra

Agra: became the capital of Sikandar Lodi in 1501, but was soon passed on to the Mughals, both Babur and Humayun's made some early Mughal constructions here. It was under Akbar that Agra first aspired to its heights of magnificence from 1570-85 he ruled from nearby Fatehpur Sikri, when he abandoned that city he moved to Lahore (now in Pakistan) but returned to Agra in 1599, all later Mughal rulers ruled from Agra till 1761 it fell to the Jats who did much damage to the city.

On arrival, check-in at hotel

Agra fort - built alongside the Yamuna River stretching almost 2.5 km. The fort's colossal double walls rise 20 m in height and measure 2.5 km in circumference. The fort is surrounded by a moat. ***During the visit, we shall arrange a short transfer on Horse carriage "Tongas"***

Later proceed to visit the Taj Mahal

"Taj Mahal – The symbol of love" (1631-1653), - a poem in white marble, built by Shah Jahan in memory of his beloved wife, Mumtaz Mahal. Rabindranath Tagore calls "a teardrop on the cheek of time". Taj Mahal means "Crown Palace" and is in fact the most well-preserved and architecturally beautiful tomb in the world. It is best described by the English poet, Sir Edwin Arnold, as "Not a piece of architecture, as other buildings are, but the proud passions of an emperor's love wrought in living stones."



(Please note that Taj Mahal is closed on every Friday)

Dinner & Overnight at hotel

Day 09	Train Agra-Jhansi & transfer to Khajuraho (158 kms/4-5 hrs)	by Shatabadi Exp.
---------------	--	--------------------------

Breakfast at hotel

Check Out from hotel & transfer to railway station to connect train for Jhansi

Depart Agra : 0830 hrs by Shatabadi Express

Arrive Jhansi : 1035 hrs

Meeting & assistance on railway station & transfer to Khajuraho

Enroute visiting Orchha

Orchha's grandeur has been captured in stone, frozen in time, a rich legacy of the ages. For this medieval city, the hand of time has rested and the palaces and the temples built by its Bundela rulers in the 16th and 17th century retain much of their pristine perfection. Jehangir Mahal, a tiered palace crowned by graceful Chhatris, commands a spectacular view of soaring temple-spires and cenotaphs.



Continue trip to Khajuraho by surface (4-5 hrs drive)

KHAJURAHO

In the temple architecture of India, the Khajuraho complex remains unique. One thousand years ago, under the generous and artistic patronage of the Chandela Rajput kings of Central India, 85 temples, magnificent in form and richly carved, came up on one site, near the village of Khajuraho. The amazingly short span of 100 years, from 950 AD - 1050 AD, saw the completion of all the temples, in an inspired burst of creativity. Today, of the original 85, only 22 have survived the ravages of time; these remain as a collective paean to life, to joy and to creativity; to the ultimate fusion of man with his creator.

On arrival, Check-In at hotel

Evening at leisure

Dinner & Overnight at hotel

Day 10	In Khajuraho
---------------	---------------------

Breakfast at hotel

Morning visit to Eastern and Western Group of Temples by bullock cart ride: - Visit the Western Group of temples, the most important temple being the Kandariya Mahadeo Temple-dedicated to Lord Shiva. It is one of the largest and most typical of the Khajuraho temples. Visit the Chaunsat Yogini Jain Temple-dedicated to the 64 "Yoginis" or attendants of Goddess Kali. This temple stands apart from the rest. Also see the Chittra-gupta or Bharatji Temple with a lovely sculpture of Lord Vishnu in his 11-headed form. The sculptures that adorn the temples, carved in stone depict gods, goddesses and amorous couples. **Later visit the Eastern Group of temples** including the Ghantai Temple, Vamana Temple dedicated to the "Vamana" or dwarf incarnation of Lord Vishnu and the Javari Temple. There are also three Jain Temples with beautiful carvings and non-erotic sculptures. Although these are Jain temples, they also contain numerous Vaishnav deities.



Afternoon Excursion to Raneh fall

In the afternoon, embark on a scenic drive to Raneh Water Falls - situated inside the Ken Gharial Sanctuary roughly 20 km from Khajuraho. Famous for its dramatic natural canyon carved by the Ken River, the site features a striking 30-meter-deep gorge lined with multi-colored crystalline granite rocks ranging from pink and red to gray and basalt. Sunlight hitting the vibrant rock formations creates a mesmerizing spectacle, while the calm surroundings offer excellent birdwatching and opportunities to spot freshwater crocodiles and endangered gharials basking along the riverbanks.

Dinner & Overnight at hotel

Day 11	Drive Khajuraho-Allahabad
---------------	----------------------------------

Breakfast at hotel

Check Out from hotel & drive to Allahabad

Allahabad: A city of many dimensions is what befits a description of Allahabad. In addition to being a major pilgrimage centre, the city has played an important part in the formation of modern India. Hindu mythology states that Lord Brahma, the creator god, chose a land for 'Prakrishta Yajna'. This land, at the confluence of three holy rivers - Ganga, Yamuna and Saraswati, blessed by gods, came to be known as 'Prayag' or 'Allahabad'. Foreseeing the sanctity of the place, Lord Brahma also called it as 'Tirth Raj' or 'King of all pilgrimage centers.' The Scriptures - Vedas and the great epics - Ramayana and Mahabharata, refer to this place as Prayag. Many important events in India's struggle for freedom, took place here - the emergence of the first Indian

National Congress in 1885, the beginning of Mahatma Gandhi's non-violence movement in 1920

Upon arrival, check in at hotel

Afternoon proceed to visit Sangam: Literally means confluence. The place has been named so because it is situated on the confluence of Ganges, Yamuna and a mythical river named Saraswati. The actual confluence is located around 7 Kilometers from the Civil Lines. The place is considered to be one of the most sacred in Hindu religion and is the site for Ardh-Kumbh and Kumbh Mela that takes every 6 and 12 years respectively.



**Followed by Boat Ride in River Ganges.
Dinner & Overnight at hotel**

Day 12

**Drive Allahabad-Varanasi
125 kms/3 hrs drive**

Breakfast at hotel

Morning visit Anand Bhawan – "the ancestral home of Jawaharlal Nehru, the freedom fighter and the first Prime-Minister of India. The place is also home to Indira Gandhi, the "Iron Lady of India". The place has today been turned into a fine museum. The importance of this place also increases because of the fact that several momentous decisions and events, related to the freedom struggle took place here. The main building houses a museum that displays the memorabilia of the Nehru family

Proceed to Varanasi by surface

VARANASI - Varanasi is one of the oldest living cities in the world. Many names have been given to Varanasi, though its recently revived official appellation is mentioned in the Mahabharata and in the Jataka tales of Buddhism. It probably derives from the two rivers that flank the city, the Varuna to the north and the Asi to the south. Many still use the anglicized forms of Banaras or Benares, while pilgrims refer to Kashi, first used three thousand years ago to describe the kingdom and the city outside which the Buddha preached his first sermon; the "City of Light" is also called Kashika, "the shining one", referring to the



light of Shiva.

Meeting and assistance on arrival and transfer to hotel

Evening, tour to downtown area in a rickshaw. Experience Varanasi, intimately when you go on a leisurely rickshaw ride through the narrow streets and alleys of Varanasi. In the evening the Ghats and temples are lit with oil-lamp lights or candles. Participate in an Aarti Ceremony (collective prayer) and watch the floating Diyas (lamps) on the river Ganges.

Dinner & Overnight at hotel

Day 13**Fly Varanasi-Delhi
By flight**

Early morning boat cruise on river Ganges. The western banks of Ganges has a string of Ghats - the chain of stone steps, all built with pavilions, palaces and terraces, most of which are mainly used as Dharamsalas where the pilgrims stay during their visit to the holy city. At dawn, the Ghats are abuzz with activity of the devotees performing their ablutions in the river or offering prayers to the rising sun and performing other religious rituals. A boat ride along the Ghats gives you vantage views of this activity. The sunrise on the Ganges is a soul-lifting experience.



On the way back to hotel visit Kalachuri Gali & Vishwanath Temple (Outside only)
(Foreigner are not allowed in the main sanctum of Temple)

Return to hotel for Breakfast

Following breakfast, proceed for the city tour of Varanasi, discovering its rich academic, artistic, and cultural landmarks.

Begin with a visit to Banaras Hindu University (BHU), one of Asia's largest residential universities and a prominent hub of learning. Nestled within its serene green campus is the renowned Bharat Kala Bhavan Museum, which houses an exceptional collection of Indian art, ancient miniature paintings, palm-leaf manuscripts, and historic sculptures. Conclude your tour at the distinctive Bharat Mata Temple, a unique shrine dedicated to Mother India that features a detailed, hand-carved relief map of undivided India sculpted entirely in marble.

Transfer to airport to connect flight for Delhi

Enroute visiting Sarnath –

Sarnath is one of Buddhism's four sacred pilgrimage sites, marking the spot where Lord Buddha delivered his first sermon after attaining enlightenment. The peaceful complex features the imposing Dhamek Stupa, the ancient ruins of the Dharmarajika Stupa, and the famous Ashoka Pillar, whose four-lion capital serves as India's national emblem. Visitors can explore tranquil monasteries built by various Buddhist nations



and visit the Sarnath Archaeological Museum, which houses an extraordinary collection of ancient Buddhist art, relics, and sculptures spanning over two millennia

Continue to airport

Depart Varanasi : 1635 hrs by Indigo flight

Arrive Delhi : 1810 hrs

Meeting & assistance on arrival and transfer to hotel (near airport) where room is booked for wash & change only

Dinner at hotel

Later in evening, departure transfer to International airport to connect flight for onward destination

Day 14

**FLY OUT FROM DELHI
by international flight**

Fly with good memories of India trip... 😊 😊

TOUR ENDS

Check In at all hotels is at 1400 hrs // Check Out time is 1200 hrs at noon